

Example	Technique	Analysis
	Close up	-The close up, at its most essential, focuses us in on human emotion, expressivity, and it does it in an intimate way. It provides us a heightened attention to the details of a character's face and the nuance that comes with it. -The close up confirms Norma's comment that she's still big ("<i>I am big; it's the pictures that got small.</i>"), depicting the overwhelming sense of pride and relevance Norma believes she still has.
	Long shot	-she is a mysterious gothic figure, shielded not only by the window shades but also by her sunglasses, confirming the impression that Joe had of her mansion. -The mansion functions as an analogue for Norma herself: just as it is decaying and hidden from the world so is she, and on in the inside it is full of pictures of Norma, confirming her narcissistic obsession with herself. -this distant first look at Norma establishes her distance, both physical and mental, from the world around her. Removing herself from an industry that has long since moved on from her, she is severely out of touch with the reality of the world outside her home. Crucially, as this same shot is from Joe's perspective, Wilder also foreshadows the more specific character 'distance' that will emerge between the two.
	Mid shot	-shows a symbolic representation of her attempts to cling on to Joe and prevent him from leaving, as his chain gets snagged by the door as he tries to exit. While his face is slightly obscured, we can detect his frustration as he makes his escape from the clutches of Norma and her mansion and tries to head back to the world he is familiar with <i>- "I didn't know where I was going. I just had to get out of there. I had to be with people my own age."</i>
	Extreme close up	<i>- "She went through a merciless series of treatments. Like an athlete training for the Olympic Games she counted every calorie, went to bed every night at nine. She was absolutely determined to be ready. Ready for those cameras that would never turn."</i> -This extreme close up is achieved not just with the camera but with the intervention of a magnifying glass, which emphasises Norma's eye in particular. The shot gives the point of view of one of the people treating Norma, taking us closer

		in the camera generally does in the close ups that Norma desires. -Notably, in the following scene, Norma, in the throes of her treatment, can't even permit Joe to look at her when she says good night as she hasn't achieved the perfection that she longs for, telling us something about the impossible demands for beauty and youth that Hollywood imposes on those who wish to be a star.
	Group shot	-<i>"She'd take me for rides in the hills above Sunset. The whole thing was upholstered in leopard skin and had one of those car phones, all gold plated."</i> -The composition of this group shot uses the dividing line of the windscreen to separate Joe and Max from Norma, suggesting a difference in status between the two men and Norma, who is effectively their employer. Joe is starting to look visibly uncomfortable in this group dynamic, as opposed to the impassive expressions on the faces of Max and Norma.
	Over the shoulder shot	-<i>"However by then I'd started concocting a little plot of my own."</i> -As Joe reads Norma's script he's unimpressed, but the camera slowly draws back into an over the shoulder shot revealing that Norma has been watching him all along. The over the shoulder emphasises this act of watching but separates us from Norma's point of view; the audience gets to see her watching Joe as he puts his plot into action to exploit Norma's wealth for his own gain, a plot which will ultimately lead to his own demise.
	Crowd shot	-<i>"Writers without a job, composers without a publisher, actresses so young they still believed the guys in the casting office. A bunch of kids who didn't give a hoot just so long as they had a yuk to share."</i> -Crowd shots are not about individuals but greater entities and this crowd shot represents the concepts of youth and fun that Joe is seeking. It's juxtaposed with Norma's empty mansion which is a place of wealth but dead on the inside. Here we see people without stable employment (which is a commentary on the tenuous nature of employment in the industry) but it is nevertheless full of life, the real and messy world that Joe has been steadily drawn away from by Norma.

	Two shot	-shows the direction in which the relationship between Norma and Joe is developing. -the two shot here is shot from an angle and puts Joe slightly in the foreground, strengthening the audience identification with Joe, whose voice-over narration has already implicitly put us on his side. -Norma is absorbed with viewing her own image on screen, a further example of the narcissistic environment she has created for herself in her mansion. -Joe's gaze, however, is directed at Norma's hand, which has clutched his arm. Joe's voice-over suggests that in this moment she is "forgetting that she's [his] employer" but her proprietorial attitude towards Joe throughout the film indicates that she hasn't forgotten at all, she is merely taking possession of what she has paid for. -There is an ironic inversion here of the typically sexist predatory behaviour of powerful men in Hollywood taking advantage of vulnerable women who are desperate to 'make it' in show business; here it is the older woman who is the predator, her hand shown as having claw-like characteristics as she latches onto her prey. -This scene is a foreshadowing of the way their relationship will develop over the course of the film.
	Establishing shot	-<i>"It was a great, big white elephant of a place, the kind crazy movie people built in the crazy twenties. A neglected house gets an unhappy look. This one had it in spades. It was like that old woman in Great Expectations, that Miss Havisham in her rotting wedding dress and torn veil, taking it out on the world because she'd been given the go-by."</i> -Joe's narration ties in with the establishing shot of Norma's mansion. -Joe's voiceover takes us in two different directions: the world of Hollywood and the world of Gothic literature, giving us an interpretive framework that guides us in particular directions. This is particularly true of the mention of Miss Havisham, so when we see Norma we associate her with the vengeful abandoned woman. -This is a sense of dread that Joe and the camera shot are establishing, and it's a clear connection of the house with the

		character: the two are fully intertwined.
	Insert	-“How could she breathe in that house so crowded with Norma Desmonds? More Norma Desmonds. And still more Norma Desmonds.” -The information that this insert of the multitude of photos reveals about Norma is the depth of her narcissism. Her obsession with her past selves is overwhelming, cluttering her mansion despite its great size. -the photographs are all of younger versions of Norma, a past which she futilely longs to recapture.
	Pan	-“Maybe you’d like to hear the facts, the whole truth. If so, you’ve come to the right party.” -The opening scenes of the film establish a mystery by starting at the end, with the death of this as yet unnamed movie writer floating in the pool. -We start out on Sunset Boulevard itself, watching police cars roar down the street with sirens wailing. A whip pan as they go past the position of the camera puts the viewer in the position of a curious onlooker, a position which is solidified as the cars enter the driveway of the mansion and the narration wonders if we’d like to hear the facts. -A pan follows the police and cameraman as they rush towards the pool. We’ve noticed something happening and the camera puts us in the position of turning our heads as we seek to sate our curiosity. -We’re rewarded by a dead body, but now our curious minds seek to discover how he came to be there; just as the narrator suggests, we want to hear the facts. Wilder uses another pan at the climax of the film when Norma shoots Joe and we follow him from right to left as we finally discover how he ended up in the pool.
	Medium shot	-Joe officially ‘loses’ Betty towards the end of the film, refusing to give up his ‘long-term contract’ with Norma. -Here, Wilder consciously frames the scene’s subject (Betty) at a distance with a medium shot. Supported by her refusal to make eye contact with Joe and her literal statement that she ‘can’t look at [him]’ we again see physical distance between the camera and the subject translating to emotional distance

		between two characters. -The impact of them no longer 'seeing eye to eye' is additionally heightened by the clear chemistry they previously demonstrated across the film.
	High angle	-we are not seeing a 'Sunset Boulevard' street sign (the more obvious choice), but instead a dirty and stained curbside. -Wilder shoots this curb from a high angle. Therefore, the film's opening shot establishes maybe the most central aim of Wilder's film; offering a critical look at the superficiality and flawed nature of Hollywood. -As such, we are literally looking down on the film industry in the first moment of the film, represented by this dirty and unflattering visual symbol of Hollywood.
	Low angle	-Wilder shoots Norma at a low angle, as Joe looks up at her haughty gaze. -On the brink of descending completely into madness and taking Joe's life, Wilder uses this shot to establish that Joe should be looking up in fear at Norma, and his dismissive and pitiful opinion of her will soon lead to his death
	Panning shot	-The camera pans horizontally downwards as Norma cascades down the stairs. Norma's decline represents the loss of her dreams as her ambition of returning back into films collapses. It is juxtaposed by her body language with her head held up high with pride, symbolizing how she is now completely consumed by her delusion, still thinking that she's a star. -<i>"The dream she had clung to had so desperately unfolded her."</i> -This quote emphasizes how deeply entrenched Norma is in her fantasy, suggests she has now been completely engrossed by her illusion, blurring the lines between her fabricated world and the reality she refuses to face.
	Mise en scene	-Joe is being dressed in a bathrobe with the blazing sun outside (and his debt collectors clearly up and doing their jobs) speaks to his slovenliness and uninvested approach to life. -The set design within this scene further characterises Joe, with the script directly describing the 'reproductions of characterless paintings' that cover his walls. -Here, the set arguably provides a visual metaphor for the

		profit-driven 'Bases Loaded' script he is writing at that very moment, later described by Betty as having come 'from hunger.'
	Mise en scene	-the house is, as Joe describes, 'crowded with Norma Desmonds', in the form of countless framed photos of her from her silent film era. -These self-portraits constantly looking out onto Norma symbolise the deluded fantasy world she has placed herself in. -They both show how this world is based around her still being a youthful and famous actress, and that this delusion is maintained through Norma only communicating inwardly, refusing to face the reality of the outside world.
	Symbol- the dead chimp	-Norma's pet monkey plays a key foreshadowing role from beyond the grave. -The chimp, a pet owned and trained by Norma to amuse her, leaves a vacant role that Joe will gradually fill after having unknowingly interrupted its funeral. -From this point in the film, Joe is manipulated, or 'trained', by Norma to entertain and provide companionship to her. -Naturally, Joe also ends up dead within the bounds of Norma's estate, with this symbol, therefore, foreshadowing the full trajectory of his character. -All of this is directly alluded to through Joe's description of the 'mixed-up dream' he has the night of the funeral, imagining 'an organ [player]' and the 'chimp...dancing for pennies' that he will soon become.
	Symbol- organ	-serves as a physical reminder of the unflattering parts of the new role Joe must play. -Included after Joe wakes from his 'mixed-up dream', the shot above frames Max's organ-playing hands as massive and overpowering, as the much-smaller Joe storms in demanding to know why his 'clothes and things' were moved to Norma's house without his say-so.

		-Crucially, Norma then reveals that she ordered this action and that Joe's apartment debts are 'all taken care of', hand-waving his attempt at grasping back some control and dignity by proposing it be 'deduct[ed]...from [his] salary'. -This scene reveals the symbolic role the organ plays within <i>Sunset Boulevard</i>, reminding Joe of the shameful and powerless role of the 'pet monkey' that he now fills, as well as what he will be 'dancing' for.
	Cinematic allusions	-Wilder does not shy away from adding an extra level of realism to his references to the film industry. -Central to this is the use of the real (and still functional) Paramount Pictures studio to which Joe attempts to sell his clichéd baseball script. Notably, this is the studio that actually released <i>Sunset Boulevard</i>, all of which adds a self-deprecating edge to the satire of the film industry these scenes contain.
-Joe's dry observation that the extravagance of the funeral for Norma's pet means that he 'must have been a very important chimp', perhaps the 'great-grandson of King Kong'. -the allusion to Charles Dickens' classic novel <i>Great Expectations</i>. Here, Joe muses that the 'unhappy look' of Norma's house reminds him of 'Miss Havisham' from this text.	Literary allusions	- these kinds of references further place the film firmly in the world of <i>real Hollywood</i>, again working to strengthen the satire it offers of this industry. -Havisham (a character, who, after being abandoned by her fiancé, refuses to change her clothing and lives secluded in a 'rotting wedding dress') directly parallels Norma, being a tragic figure immovably stuck in the past, with Norma's excessive placement of young self-portraits being reminiscent of Havisham's insistence on keeping her house's clocks at the exact time she received her letter of marital rejection. -Further, the eventual fate of Miss Havisham within <i>Great Expectations</i>, with her wedding dress catching fire and leaving her as an invalid, foreshadows Norma's similar descent to invalidity through her madness.